Methane Gas Sensor

SMD1008 Product Datasheet

1. Product Introduction

The SMD1008 methane sensor is a semiconductor gas sensor developed by MEMS technology and can be used to detect the methane gas content in different scenarios.

The methane gas sensitive material and sensing electrodes are developed and made by IDM independently. When the sensitive material is exposed to methane gas, the conductivity of the sensitive material will change. A specific circuit can be used to convert the conductivity change into an output voltage signal corresponding to the gas concentration.

2. Sensor Characteristics

- Small size
- Low power consumption
- High sensitivity
- Fast response and recovery time
- Simple test circuit
- Good stability
- Long life time

3. Main Application

- Methane gas leak monitoring devices
- Fire/safety detection systems for homes, factories and commercial uses
- Combustible gas leak alarm, gas leak detector
- Smart gas meter, gas water heater, gas integrated stove, kitchen hood, etc

4. Product Description

4.1 Technical parameters

Table 1

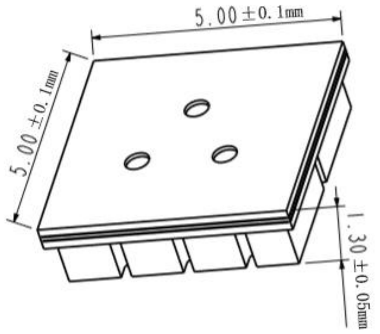
Product Number			SMD1008
Standard Package			Ceramic Package
Target Gas			Methane
Measurement Rang			0 ～ 10000ppm methane
Resolution			500 ppm
Standard Electrical Parameters	Sensor Voltage	V_C	≤5 V DC
	Heating Voltage	V_H	1.8 ±0.05 V DC
	Load Resistance	R	Adjustable (subject to delivery report)
Gas Sensor Characteristics Under standard Test Conditions	Heater Resistance	R_H	43 ± 5 Ω (measured at room temperature)
	Heating Power consumption	P_H	≤30 mW
	Sensor Resistance	R_S	5 ~ 300 KΩ (tested in air)
	Sensitivity	S	R 0 (in air)/Rs (in 5000ppm methane) ≥ 5
	Response Ratio	α	≤ 0.5 (R 5000ppm / R 1000 ppm methane)
Standard Test Conditions	Temperature Humidity		20±2℃ 55±5%RH
	Preheat Time		≥ 3 min
Response Time (T_{90})			< 15 s
Recovery Time (T_{10})			< 30 s
Life Time			≥ 3 years

Note: in following section, if the unit is resistance, it is calculated by this formula:

$$R = \frac{R_L(V_{CC} - V_{OUT})}{V_{OUT}}$$

Each item definition refer table1

4.2 Sensor structure and Pin definition



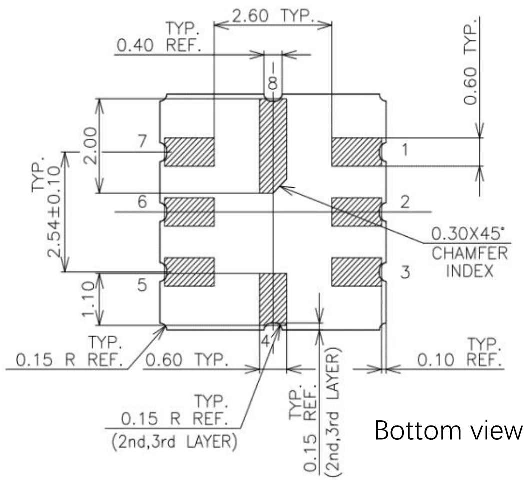


Table 2

Pin Number	Name	Definition
1	VH+	Heating voltage supply
2	VCC	Sensor voltage supply
3	NG	/
4	NG	/
5	NG	/
6	NG	/
7	HOT	Heater GND
8	VOUT	Sensor output voltage

4.3 Basic Circuit

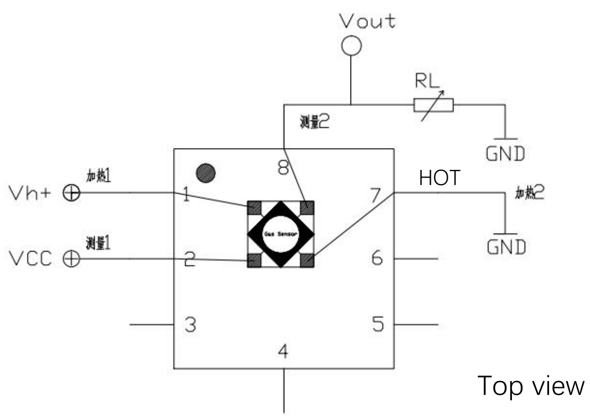


Figure shows the basic test circuit for SMD1008 sensor. The sensor needs to apply 2 voltages: heater voltage (Vh) and sensor test voltage (Vcc). Vh+ is a specific voltage for the sensor heating element. Vcc is the sensor voltage. Vout is output reading voltage which need connect the load resistor RL in series. These two voltage need set in right value according to datasheet, otherwise measurement performance will reduce and even damage the sensor.

5. Sensor Characterization

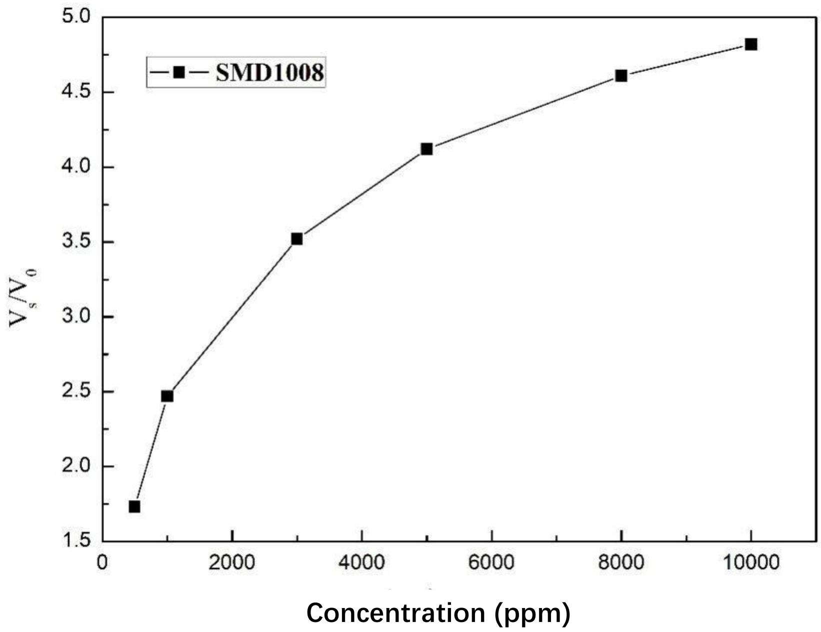


Figure 1 Methane sensor sensitivity characteristic curve

The test was completed under standard test conditions, and the load resistance used was 2kΩ. In the figure, V0 represents the output voltage value to clean air, and Vs represents the output voltage value to methane gas in different concentrations.

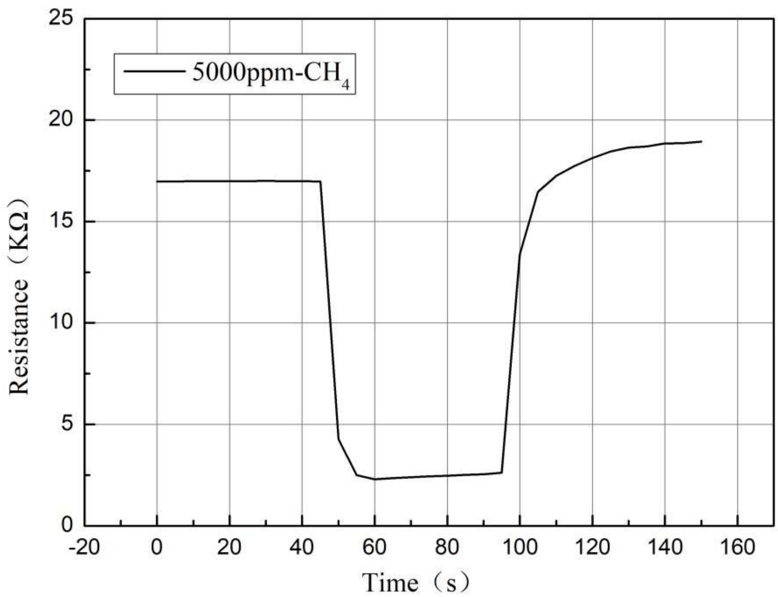


Figure 2 Sensor response-recovery characteristic curve

The curve in the figure shows the real-time voltage value read out from the sensor. The test gas is 5000ppm methane. The test was completed under standard test conditions.

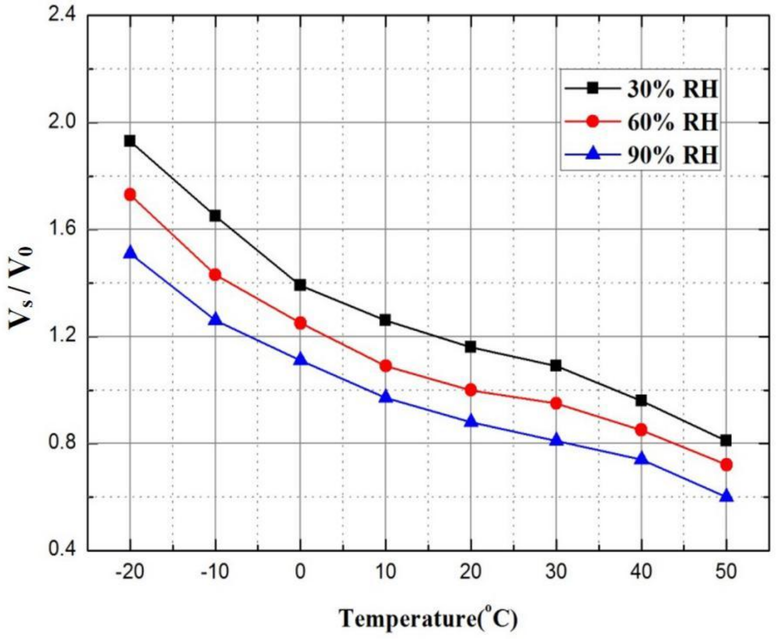


Figure 3 Temperature and humidity characteristic curve of the sensor

Above figure shows the temperature and humidity effect curves, Vs represents the response voltage in 5000 ppm methane gas under different temperature and humidity conditions, and V0 represents the response voltage value in clean air under correspond temperature and humidity conditions.

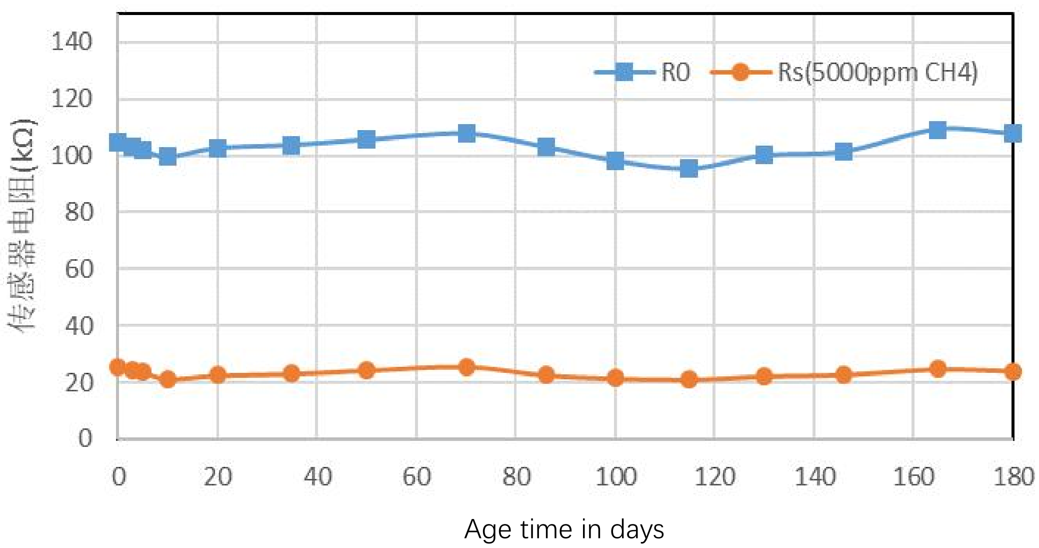


Figure 4 Long-term stability curve of the sensor

All tests in the figure were completed under standard test conditions. The horizontal axis is the continuous working time of the sensor, and the vertical axis is the resistance value of the methane sensor. Rs represents the resistance value of the sensor in 5000 ppm methane concentrations, and R_0 represents the resistance value of the sensor in clean air.

6. Product Shipping Packaging:

Generally shipped in carrier tape packaging. Customer can request other package when place the purchase.

Precautions:

1 Situations must be avoid

1.1 Exposure to volatile silicon compound vapor

The sensor should avoid being exposed to silicone adhesives, hair spray, silicone rubber, putty or other places where volatile silicone compounds exist. If the surface of the sensor is adsorbed with silicone compound vapor, the sensitive material of the sensor will be wrapped by silicon dioxide which formed by the decomposition of the silicone compound, which will degrade the sensitivity of the sensor and cannot be restored.

1.2 Highly corrosive environment

The sensor is exposed to high concentration of corrosive gas (such as H 2 S, SO X , Cl 2 , HCl, etc.), it will not only cause corrosion or damage to the heating material and sensor leads, but also cause irreversible deterioration of the performance of sensitive materials.

1.3 Pollution by alkali, alkali metal salts and halogens

The performance of the sensor may also deteriorate when it is contaminated by alkali metals, especially salt water spray, or exposed to halogens such as Freon.

1.4 Directly touch with water

If the sensor is splashed with water or immersed in water, the sensitivity of the sensor will decrease, which will affect the measurement accuracy of the sensor.

1.5 Freeze

If sensor surface appear with ice, it will cause sensing material crack and lost sensitive property.

1.6 Applied voltage is too high

If the voltage applied to the sensor or heater is higher than the specified value, even if the sensor is not physically damaged or destroyed, it may cause damage to the leads and/or heater and cause the sensor's sensitivity characteristics to degrade.

1.7 Voltage pins mismatched

If the wrong voltage is applied to the sensor or heating and signal pins, it may cause damage to the leads and/or heater and cause the sensor's sensitivity to deteriorate.

2. Situations need attention

2.1 Condensation

Under indoor use conditions, slight condensation will have small impact on the sensor performance. However, if water condenses on the surface of the sensitive layer and remains for a long time, the sensor characteristics may deteriorate.

2.2 In high concentration gas

Regardless of whether the sensor is powered on or not, long-term place in high-concentration gas will affect the sensor characteristics. For example, if the sensor directly be spray by lighter gas (butane), that will cause great damage to the sensor.

2.3 Long-term storage

If the sensor is stored for a long time without power on, its resistance will have a reversible drift, which is related to the storage environment. The sensor should be stored in a sealed bag that does not contain volatile silicon compounds. After long-term storage, the sensor needs a longer time preheat process to stabilize. The storage time and corresponding preheating time are recommended as following:

Storage time	Recommended preheating time
Less than 1 month	Not less than 6 hours
1-6 months	Not less than 12 hours
More than 6 months	Not less than 24 hours

2.4 Long-term exposure to extreme environments

Regardless of whether the sensor is powered or not, to exposure in extreme conditions, such as high humidity, high temperature or high pollution for long time, it will seriously affect sensor performance.

2.5 Vibration

Frequently, excessively vibration may cause the sensor's internal leads to break. This type of vibration can be generated during transportation and by using pneumatic screwdrivers or ultrasonic welders on the assembly line.

2.6 Impact

If the sensor is subjected to a strong impact or falls, internal lead wires may break.

2.7 Conditions of assembling:

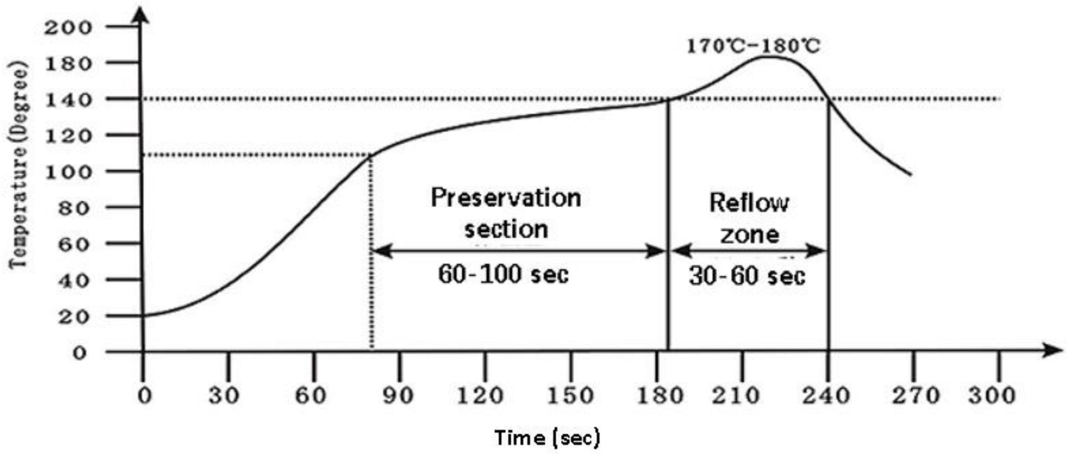
2.7.1 Manual welding is the ideal welding method for sensors. The recommended welding conditions are as following:

- Flux: Rosin flux with minimal chlorine content
- Constant temperature soldering iron
- Temperature: 250℃
- Time: no more than 3 seconds

2.7.2 The following conditions are recommended when using reflow soldering:

Solder paste: low temperature lead-free solder paste (Sn42Bi58)

The furnace curve is as following:



2.8 Anti-static

Anti-static bag packaging

Violation of the above usage conditions will degrade the sensor characteristics.

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